

Commission plans new China trade measures by year's end

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BRUSSELS — Brussels plans to introduce measures in the fourth quarter of the year to diversify European industry supply chains away from China, accord
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Commission plans new China trade measures by year's end
By Carlo Martuscelli · Sep 29, 2026, 5:17 PM · View in your browser

BRUSSELS — Brussels plans to introduce measures in the fourth quarter of the year to diversify European industry supply chains away from China, according to a call for evidence published Tuesday.

The document names the package "DiversifyEU" and says it will be overseen by the European Commission's trade department. The package's exact legal form has yet to be determined but it would include a "trade diversification instrument" that would include the possibility of imposing tariffs.

The EU executive's request for feedback doesn't name China outright, but it does cite a call by EU leaders for tougher trade measures. EU leaders tasked the Commission at their Brussels summit in June with developing new tools to tackle the flood of Chinese exports entering the single market.

China is the EU's biggest source of goods imports , accounting for more than a fifth of the bloc's imports. Commission President Ursula von der Leyen has said that she wants to de-risk from the Asian economy and, at her annual address to the EU earlier this month, she said the EU-China trade deficit had reached a "tipping point."

The EU's reliance on imports from China is most acute in the area of critical minerals — industrial inputs such as lithium, cobalt, and rare earth metals used in high-tech applications. For some minerals that dependence exceeds 90% of all imports.

According to the Commission document, the current rules don't go far enough to nudge businesses in so-called critical sectors — which it doesn't name — to buy from multiple suppliers. The document also points to a lack of incentives to encourage diversification and a lack of market-monitoring data.

The EU executive acknowledges that new rules will involve "adjustment costs" for the affected sectors, though it writes that these should be "weighed against" the security risks of not diversifying.

Respondents have a month to submit their feedback.

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